GUIDANCE NOTES — remove these notes before sending

Security deposit — statement of deductions

When to use

- You are the landlord, the tenant has moved out, and you are keeping part of the security deposit to cover damage or other amounts.

The rules in plain English

- The landlord may take a security deposit to ensure maintenance of the property at the end of the lease, and undertakes to refund it, or what remains of it, at expiry (Art. 20).
- The tenant must return the property in the same condition as received, except ordinary wear and tear or damage due to reasons beyond the tenant's control (Art. 21).
- The law does not define 'ordinary wear and tear', and it sets no cap on the deposit and no deadline for the refund beyond 'upon the expiry'.

Build each deduction on evidence

- For each item, show its condition at move-in (T07 move-in checklist, dated photos) and at move-out (T08 move-out checklist, dated photos).
- Attach a contractor quote or invoice for each amount.
- Refund the balance promptly and say how and when it will be paid.

If the tenant disagrees

- Give the tenant a date to reply in writing. If you cannot agree, either party may take the matter to the Rental Disputes Center, which has exclusive jurisdiction over Dubai rent disputes, with some exceptions such as free zones with their own rent tribunal (Decree 26/2013 Art. 6).

What this template does not do

- This template is general information. It does not decide whether the rule applies to your situation, and it does not interpret your tenancy contract. Disputes are decided by the Rental Disputes Center (Decree 26/2013).

Legal basis (official sources, retrieved 2026-11-03)

- Law 26/2007 Art. 20 (deposit) and Art. 21 (return condition) — https://dlp.dubai.gov.ae/Legislation%20Reference/2007/Law%20No.%20(26)%20of%202007%20Regarding%20regulation%20between%20the%20lessor%20and%20the%20lessee.html
- Decree 26/2013 Art. 6 (Rental Disputes Center jurisdiction) — https://dlp.dubai.gov.ae/Legislation%20Reference/2013/Decree%2026%20of%202013.html

The English texts are the official translations published by the Supreme Legislation Committee, Dubai; the Arabic text prevails in case of conflict.

General information and templates only, not legal advice. For your specific case consult a licensed legal practitioner in the UAE.

[Sender's name and address, or letterhead]

Date: **[DD Month YYYY]**

To: **[Tenant full name, as in the tenancy contract]**

From: **[Landlord full name]**

Agent (delete this line if none): **[agent name]**, authorised under **[power of attorney / management agreement ref]**

Property: **[unit no.]**, **[building]**, **[community]**, Dubai

Ejari no.: **[number]** · Tenancy contract dated **[date]**, expiring on **[expiry date]**

Security deposit — statement of deductions

Dear **[tenant name]**,

1. The tenancy of the property above ended on **[end date]**. You returned the keys on **[date]**, and the move-out inspection took place on **[date]**, attended by **[names]**.

2. Under Article 20 of Law No. 26 of 2007, the deposit is refunded, or what remains of it, at the end of the tenancy. Under Article 21, the property is returned in the condition received, except ordinary wear and tear. The deductions below relate to items that were in better condition at move-in, as shown in the attached checklists and photos.

No.	Item and location	At move-in (checklist / photo ref)	At move-out (checklist / photo ref)	AED	Quote / invoice
1	**[item]**	**[ref]**	**[ref]**	**[amount]**	**[ref]**
2	**[item]**	**[ref]**	**[ref]**	**[amount]**	**[ref]**
3	**[item]**	**[ref]**	**[ref]**	**[amount]**	**[ref]**

Security deposit held	AED **[deposit]**
Total deductions	AED **[total deductions]**
Balance to refund	AED **[balance]**

3. The balance of AED **[balance]** will be paid by **[bank transfer / cheque]** to **[account / name]** on or before **[date]**.

4. If you disagree with any item, please reply in writing by **[reply date]** with your reasons, so we can try to settle it.

Yours sincerely,

Signature: _____

Name: **[full name]** · Capacity: **[Landlord / authorised agent of the landlord]**

Phone / email: **[contact details]**

*Attachments: move-in checklist dated **[date]**; move-out checklist dated **[date]**; photos **[nos.]**; quotes/invoices **[refs]**.*

Proof of delivery (keep with your copy)

Method	Reference / evidence	Date
Registered mail	**[ref]**	**[date]**
Email to **[address]** — keep the sent copy	**[ref]**	**[date]**
By hand — tenant's signature below	**[ref]**	**[date]**
Other: **[method]**	**[ref]**	**[date]**

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Received by tenant (hand delivery): Name [ ] · Signature _____ · Date [ ]